Class 12th Vistas Study Material

Chapter-1 The Third Level

Theme

The theme of The Third Level by Jack Finney revolves around the escape from reality and the human desire for peace and security. It explores the concept of alternate realities and time travel, reflecting on how people seek refuge from modern life's complexities and stresses through imagination and fantasy.

Character Sketch of Charley

- Nervous person.
- Young or optimist man,
- Hobby was collecting stamps.
- Afraid to live in the violent society
- Desire to visit a peaceful and idyllic place.
- He regularly expresses his desire to escape the ordinary reality of his daily existence and is also a dreamer.

Character Sketch of Louisa

- A practical, level-headed, and rational person.
- Louisa helps her husband stay grounded by reminding him of his responsibilities
- Portrayed as being a loving and understanding wife
- Kind

Character Sketch of Sam

- Psychiatrist
- Practical and sensible individual who enjoys his life.

Extract based questions

1. Read the following extracts and answer the questions :

Anyway, here's what happened at Grand Central. One night last summer I worked late at the office. I was in a hurry to get uptown to my apartment so I decided to take the subway from Grand Central because it's faster than the bus.

Now, I don't know why this should have happened to me. I'm just an ordinary guy named Charley, thirty-one years old, and I was wearing a tan gabardine suit and a straw hat with a fancy band; I passed a dozen men who looked just like me.

(i) List any two details about how Charley was dressed up.

Ans. Charley was wearing a tan gabardine suit and a straw hat with a fancy band.

(ii) Charley decided to use the subway because it was :

(A) quicker.

(B) cheaper.

(C) more fashionable.

(D) safer.

Ans. (A) quicker.

(iii) Complete the following sentence appropriately.

Landing at the third level was due to Charley's flight of _____.

Ans. imagination.

(iv) Which time frame is represented through the kind of outfit mentioned in the extract?

(A) pre world war era

(B) the present times

(C) the eighteenth century

(D) in the future

Ans. (B) the present times

2. Read the following extracts and answer the questions :

To make sure, I walked over to a newsboy and glanced at the stack of papers at his feet. It was The World; and The World hasn't been published for years. The lead story said something about President

Cleveland. I've found that front page since, in the Public Library files, and it was printed June 11, 1894.

I turned toward the ticket window knowing that here — on the third level at Grand Central — I could buy tickets that would take Louisa and me anywhere in the United States we wanted to go.

(i) Why does the narrator resort to wishful day-dreaming and want to travel back in time?

Ans. The narrator resorts to wishful daydreaming and wants to travel back in time to escape the stress and chaos of his present life, finding solace in the simplicity and tranquillity of the past.

(ii) The year 1894 holds so much importance because _____.

Ans. It represents a time before the two World Wars, a period of peace and stability that the narrator longs for.

(iii) The World, the news about President Cleveland — what do they hint at?

(A) The narrator used to like reading the newspaper.

(B) The narrator fantasises about past events.

(C) The narrator wants to escape to a world that was unaffected by the two World Wars.

(D) The narrator tends to forget things.

Ans. (C) The narrator wants to escape to a world that was unaffected by the two World Wars.

(iv) Give one reason why the writing style of the extract can be called autobiographical.

Ans. The writing style can be called autobiographical because it reflects the narrator's personal thoughts, feelings, and experiences, blurring the lines between reality and imagination.

3. Read the following extract and answer the questions that follow:

The clerk figured the fare — he glanced at my fancy hat band, but he figured the fare — and I had enough for two coach tickets, one way. But when I counted out the money and looked up, the clerk was staring at me. He nodded at the bills. "That ain't money, mister," he said, "and if you're trying to skin me, you won't get very far," and he glanced at the cash drawer, beside him. Of course the money was old-style bills half again as big as the money we use nowadays and different looking.

(i) Why did Charley ask for two tickets?

Ans. Charley asked for two tickets because he had decided to go to Galesburg in 1894's time with his wife Louisa.

(ii) Complete the sentence by choosing the correct option :

When Charley offered money to the booking clerk, the latter stared at Charley because the booking clerk

(a) thought it wasn't money .

(b) did not trust Charley.

(c) thought Charley was trying to tease him.

(d) thought that Charley had given him less money.

Ans. (a) thought it wasn't money.

(iii) Select the option that best describes Charley in this extract. He is

(a) a cheat

(b) gullible

(c) an opportunist

(d) an escapist

Ans. (a) a cheat

(iv) 'If you're trying to skin me' suggests _____.

Ans. that the clerk thought about the protagonist 'Charley' to be a cheater and if he dared to cheat, he would be caught very soon.

Short type questions

1. Louisa behaves like a perfect wife. Give evidence from The Third Level in support of the above statement. [40-50 Words]

Ans. Louisa demonstrates her role as an ideal wife by standing by Charley in his search for the third level, even though it seems illogical. She listens to his thoughts, shares his curiosity, and even suggests he consult a psychiatrist. Her care and understanding reflect her supportive nature.

2. ‘My three hundred dollars bought less than two hundred in old style bills, but I didn’t care.’

What prompted Charlie to compromise on less value of money? [40-50 Words]

Ans. Charlie accepted the reduced value of his three hundred dollars because he was eager to travel back to Galesburg in 1894, a time when things were much cheaper. His desire to experience that simpler time outweighed the lower exchange rate he received for his money.

3. Jack Finney portrays Louisa as a perfect wife. Give evidences from Charlie’s life in support of the above statement. [40-50 Words]

AnsLouisa proves to be the perfect wife by defending Charley when Sam hints that Charley might be unhappy. She believes Sam is blaming her for his distress. Concerned about Charley's mental well-being, she is protective and discourages him from pursuing the search for the third level.

4. Why was Charlie fascinated with Galesburg? [40-50 Words]

Ans. Charlie was drawn to Galesburg because it represented an era of peace and simplicity, offering a stark contrast to the complexities and anxieties of modern life. He saw it as a place of tranquility, where life was easier and less stressful, which deeply fascinated him.

5. My stamp collecting, for example, that's a temporary refuge from reality.

How can a hobby give one an escape from reality? [40-50 Words]

Ans. Engaging in a hobby provides an escape by diverting one's attention from current issues or anxieties. Immersing oneself in a hobby allows the mind to focus on something pleasant and distracting, offering a temporary break from the harshness of reality.

6. In the story 'The Third Level', reality and fantasy are interwoven. Justify. [120-150 Words]

Ans. In The Third Level by Jack Finney, reality and fantasy are intricately blended to create a narrative that challenges the boundary between them. Charley discovers a mysterious third level at Grand Central Station, transporting him to the peaceful world of 1890s Galesburg. This represents an escape from the stresses of contemporary life. While his friends and wife dismiss it as a fantasy, Charley's desire for a simpler, calmer life contrasts sharply with the struggles of modern existence. The ambiguity of whether the third level is real or imagined invites readers to question what is real, highlighting the need for escapism and hope for a better, peaceful world.

7. What did Charley find in his collection of first day covers? [40-50 Words

Ans. One night, while sorting through his stamp collection, Charley found a first-day cover with a letter from Sam to him. It included a six-cent stamp from 1894, with a picture of President Garfield. The letter directed Charley to go back with Louisa to the third level and continue searching until he found it.

8. Why did Charley buy old-style currency? [40-50 Words]

Ans. Charley purchased old-style currency to buy tickets for a trip to Galesburg, a place he believed was peaceful and idyllic, with large trees and charming houses. Despite the diminished value of the money, he was determined to travel there, yet he never returned to the third level.

9. Do you think that the third level was a medium of escape? Why / Why not? [40-50 Words]

Ans. Yes, the third level acted as an escape for Charley. Modern life, filled with stress, insecurity, and conflict, was overwhelming for him. He sought refuge in the third level, where life seemed peaceful and serene. Charley’s psychiatrist friend even referred to it as a "walking dream wish fulfillment," reflecting Charley's desire to escape reality. His hobby of stamp collecting also provided temporary relief from his anxieties.

10. What extraordinary experience did Charley have when he went to the Grand station? [40-50 Words]

Ans. When Charley visited Grand Central Station, he found it to be an unfamiliar, labyrinth-like space, expanding with new passageways and

stairways. During his visit, he discovered the third level, an extraordinary, hidden part of the station that seemed to offer an entryway into the past.

Chapter- 2 The Tiger King

Theme

The theme of The Tiger King by Kalki Krishnamurthy explores the dangers of absolute power, arrogance, and obsession. It critiques the ruler's hubris and his disregard for life, symbolized by his obsession with killing tigers. The story highlights the inevitability of fate and the consequences of one’s reckless actions.

Extract based questions

Q1. Read the following extracts and answer the questions :

From that day onwards it was celebration time for all the tigers inhabiting Pratibandapuram.

The State banned tiger hunting by anyone except the Maharaja. A proclamation was issued to the effect that if anyone dared to fling so much as a stone at a tiger, all his wealth and property would be confiscated.

The Maharaja vowed he would attend to all other matters only after killing the hundred tigers. Initially the king seemed well set to realise his ambition.

(i) Select the correct option :

‘… he would attend to all other matters only after killing hundred tigers’. This reflects Tiger King’s

(A) courage

(B) determination

(C) selfishness

(D) kindness

Ans. (B) determination

(ii) Complete the sentence appropriately.

From that day onwards it was celebration time for all the tigers. The above statement is ironical in the sense _____.

Ans. From that day onwards it was celebration time for all the tigers. The above statement is ironical in the sense that while it seems like good news for the tigers, it actually means they are in greater danger because the king is hunting them.

(iii) ‘… if anyone dared to fling so much as a stone at a tiger, all his wealth and property would be confiscated’.

What trait of the king is reflected in the above line?

Ans. The king is shown to be authoritarian and strict, enforcing severe punishment for harming tigers.

(iv) State whether the following statement is TRUE or FALSE.

The King's ambition is to save people from the tigers.

Ans. FALSE

Short type questions

1. Why did the shopkeeper sell the wooden tiger at a cheap price? [40-50 Words]

Ans. The wooden tiger was crafted by a builder who wasn't very skilled, leaving it rough with uneven surfaces. Due to its poor quality, it was sold for a mere two and a quarter annas. However, the shopkeeper feared punishment from the king if he revealed the low price, so he inflated its cost.

2. Did the Tiger King manage to kill the hundredth tiger? Why / Why not? [40-50 Words]

Ans. The Tiger King aimed at the tiger, but the bullet missed and only knocked the tiger unconscious. The shooters, not wanting the king to know, killed the tiger themselves, leading the king to believe he had completed his goal of killing the hundredth tiger.

3. In what way did the infant Tiger King surprise the astrologer? [40-50 Words]

Ans When the Tiger King was just ten days old, the royal astrologer predicted he would grow into a great warrior but would die at the hands of a tiger. The infant, Jilani Jung Jung Bahadur, responded by

stating that everyone dies eventually and questioned how his father had died, showing surprising wisdom for such a young child.

4. Do you agree with the Tiger King’s statement? You may kill even a cow in self defence. [40-50 Words]

Ans. I disagree with the Tiger King's statement. He believed it was justified to kill a tiger, just as one might kill a cow in self-defense. However, humanity has historically caused harm to nature and wildlife due to neglect. We must adopt a mindset to protect all living creatures and maintain balance in nature.

5. What did the Maharaja and dewan do to avoid the danger of losing the throne? [40-50 Words]

Ans. The Maharaja faced the risk of losing his throne after refusing a British officer permission to hunt tigers in his kingdom. To prevent this, he sent expensive diamond rings to the officer’s wife. However, she kept all fifty rings, and the Maharaja, having spent three lakh rupees, was relieved that his throne was secured.

6. What did the Maharaja do to realize his ambition of killing hundred tigers? [40-50 Words]

Ans. After exhausting all tiger-hunting opportunities in his own kingdom, the Maharaja married into a neighboring kingdom known for its high tiger population. This strategy allowed him to continue his mission of killing one hundred tigers.

7. Who was the Tiger King? How did he get the name Tiger King? [40-50 Words]

Ans. The Tiger King, or Maharaja of Pratibandapuram, was Crown Prince Jung Jung Bahadur. He earned the name due to the prediction by an astrologer that he would die at the hands of a tiger. As an infant, he growled upon hearing this, symbolizing his defiance and leading to his name, Tiger King.

8. What message does the story “The Tiger King” give to the readers? [40-50 Words]

Ans The story conveys that no matter how powerful a person is, they cannot escape their fate. Despite the Tiger King's efforts to defy his destiny by killing tigers, he met his end in an ironic manner—through a toy tiger, which symbolized his unavoidable fate.

9. Which problem did the Maharaja face after killing seventy tigers when he had vowed to kill 100 tigers? [40-50 Words]

Ans After hunting all the tigers in his kingdom, the Maharaja faced a dilemma in fulfilling his vow to kill one hundred tigers. To overcome this, he married into a kingdom with a large tiger population, allowing him to continue his quest.

10. Why did the Maharaja have to pay a bill of three lakh rupees to the British jewellers? [40-50 Words]

Ans The Maharaja had to pay a bill of three lakh rupees to a British jeweler because he wanted to appease the British officer’s wife after

refusing permission for a tiger hunt in his kingdom. The jeweler sent fifty diamond rings as samples, but the officer's wife kept all of them, leaving the Maharaja with a hefty bill.

Q11. What was the hidden agenda behind the Tiger King's marriage with the princess in the neighbouring state? [40-50 Words]

Ans The Tiger King's true motive behind marrying the princess from a neighboring state was to gain access to a kingdom rich in tigers. This was essential for him to complete his goal of killing one hundred tigers.

Q12. What did the astrologers predict about the child when he was born? [40-50 words]

Ans. The astrologers predicted that the child would grow up to be a great warrior but would ultimately die at the hands of a tiger. Since he was born during the hour of the bull, they believed a tiger, as the enemy of the bull, would be the cause of his death.

Q13. What was the Maharaja's mission? How did he resolve to overcome the obstacles in the fulfilment of his mission? [120-150 Words]

Ans. The Tiger King's mission was to kill one hundred tigers to defy a prophecy that he would die at the hands of a tiger. To achieve this, he sought to eliminate all the tigers in his kingdom. When he ran out of tigers, he married into a neighboring kingdom with a high tiger

population to continue his mission. He managed to kill ninety-nine tigers, but when his men found a weak, old tiger for the final kill, the king’s bullet only stunned it. Ironically, the tiger did not kill him, but he was later fatally injured by a toy tiger, fulfilling the astrologer's prophecy.

Chapter-3 Journey to the End of the Earth

Theme

The theme of Journey to the End of the Earth by Tishani Doshi explores the significance of understanding and preserving the natural world. It reflects on the beauty and fragility of Antarctica, emphasizing the interconnectedness of all life and the importance of environmental conservation in the face of climate change.

Character Sketch of Tishani Doshi

- A young, beautiful, and adventurous
- Enthusiasm
- Has a cheerful, outgoing personality
- Quite enthusiastic about travelling to Antarctica.
- Wants to use her poems to spread awareness
- She was resilient and determined

Extract based question

Q1. Read the following extracts and answer the questions :

Human civilisations have been around for a paltry 12,000 years – barely a few seconds on the geological clock. In that short amount of time, we've managed to create quite a rukus, etching our dominance over nature with our villages, towns, cities, mega cities. The rapid increase of human populations has left us battling with other species for limited resources, and the unmitigated burning of fossil fuels has now created a blanket of carbon dioxide around the world, which is slowly but surely increasing the average global temperature.

(i) According to the view expressed by the author in the above extract, increase in global temperature is due to

(A) mega cities

(B) human people

(C) burning of fossil fuels

(D) limited resources

Ans. (C) burning of fossil fuels

(ii) Complete the following sentence with reference to the extract :

Humans are criticised by the author for _____.

Ans. Humans are criticised by the author for causing environmental damage and increasing global temperatures.

(iii) According to the author, the relation between human population and resources is _____.

Ans. According to the author, the relation between human population and resources is one of competition and conflict over limited resources.

(iv) 'In that short amount of time, we've managed to create a ruckus'. By 'ruckus' the author refers to _____.

(A) movement.

(B) misunderstanding

(C) breach

(D) commotion

Ans. (D) commotion

Q2. Read the following extracts and answer the questions :

The reason the programme has been so successful is because it is impossible to go anywhere near the South Pole and not be affected by it. It's easy to be blase about polar ice caps melting while sitting in the comfort zone of our respective latitude and longitude, but when you can visibly see glaciers retreating and ice shelves collapsing, you begin to realise that the threat of global warming is real.

Antarctica, because of her simple eco-system and lack of biodiversity, is the perfect place to study how little changes in the environment can have big repercussions. (Journey to the End of the Earth)

(i) As per the given extract, the reason for the success of the programme is

(A) the participation of young students.

(B) the journey to Antarctica.

(C) the exposure to reality.

(D) it was impossible to go near south pole.

Ans. (C) the exposure to reality.

(ii) Complete the following sentence.

The warning that can be inferred from the above extract is _____.

Ans. The warning that can be inferred from the above extract is that global warming is a significant and urgent threat, visibly affecting the polar ice caps and ecosystems.

(iii) State whether the statement given is TRUE or FALSE with reference to the extract.

Global warming is a threat to human survival.

Ans. TRUE

(iv) Explain one inference that can be drawn from the line “It’s easy to be blase about polar ice caps melting while sitting in the comfort zone”.

Ans. People often ignore or underestimate the severity of global warming when they do not directly witness its impacts.

Short type question

1. How can you say ‘Students on Ice Programme’ was a step towards the future? [40-50 Words]

Ans. The ‘Students on Ice Programme’ is a forward-thinking initiative as it educates youth about the environmental challenges Antarctica faces. By raising awareness, it empowers the next generation to take responsibility in protecting the environment and preserving the planet for future generations.

2. ‘And for humans, the prognosis is not good;’

What is in store for humans, as per the above statement? [40-50 Words]

Ans. According to the statement, the future for humans appears grim. The delicate balance of Earth's ecosystems is being disrupted by human activities, leading to negative consequences. If left unchecked, the impact of these actions could be disastrous for human life and the environment.

3. “With students on ice, he offers future generation of policy makers a life-changing experience…’

What expectation of the narrator is reflected in the above line? [40-50 Words]

Ans : The narrator expected that the experience would allow students to witness the realities of environmental damage firsthand. The programme gave them an immersive learning opportunity to understand the challenges our planet faces and inspired them to become active in making a difference.

4. “My Antarctic experience was full of such epiphanies,” says Tishani Doshi. Which experience does she consider the best and why? [40-50 Words]

Ans. Tishani Doshi regards the breathtaking beauty of Antarctica as the most significant experience. This awe-inspiring sight made her realize how fragile the environment is and deepened her understanding of how human actions are affecting the planet, emphasizing the importance of environmental conservation.

5. Tishani Doshi considered the programme ‘Students on Ice’ a success. Do you agree with her? Why/Why not? [40-50 Words]

Ans. Yes, Tishani Doshi considered the ‘Students on Ice’ programme successful because it offered students an exceptional chance to directly engage with the environmental challenges faced by the polar regions. This exposure motivated them to recognize the urgency of preserving the planet and to take meaningful action.

6. What are Geoff Green’s reasons for including high school students in the ‘Students on Ice’ expedition? [40-50 Words]

Ans. Geoff Green included high school students in the ‘Students on Ice’ expedition because he believed that young people are the future stewards of the planet. By immersing them in the realities of environmental degradation, he aimed to inspire them to play a key role in shaping a sustainable future.

7. Describe Gondwana. [40-50 Words]

Ans. Gondwana was a vast southern supercontinent, rich in flora and fauna, which existed millions of years ago. It included regions that are now separate continents, such as India and Antarctica. Over time, Gondwana broke apart, leading to the formation of the continents as we know them today.

8. What did Geoff Green switch over to? Why? [40-50 Words]

Ans. Geoff Green shifted from teaching to leading educational expeditions to Antarctica. He wanted to provide high school students with an opportunity to experience the planet's environmental issues firsthand, believing that they would be more motivated to take action than adults focused on entertainment and leisure.

9. What were the author’s initial emotions on setting foot in Antarctica? [40-50 Words]

Ans. The narrator's initial emotions upon arriving in Antarctica included a sense of awe and wonder. The vast, untouched landscape, coupled with the extreme conditions, left a deep impression. The experience highlighted both the beauty and fragility of nature, making the narrator reflect on humanity’s place in the world.

10. Why did Derry enter Mr. Lamb’s garden? [40-50 Words]

Ans. Derry entered Mr. Lamb’s garden because he felt isolated due to his disfigured face and believed the garden was empty. Seeking solitude, he climbed over the wall, but his encounter with Mr. Lamb was unexpected, leaving him surprised by the encounter and the man’s wisdom.

11. What are the significant features of ‘Students on Ice Programme’? [40-50 Words]

Ans. The ‘Students on Ice Programme’ takes students to Antarctica, offering them an educational opportunity to better understand the environment. It provides future policymakers with a transformative experience, raising awareness about the real-world effects of climate change and fostering a deeper respect for the planet.

12. What makes the author say, “The world’s geological history is trapped in Antarctica”? [40-50 Words]

Ans. The author suggests that Antarctica holds key geological evidence from millions of years ago, specifically from the supercontinent Gondwana. This frozen landmass holds a record of Earth’s past, revealing insights about the planet’s history and the early stages of the continents’ formation.

13. What prevented the Shokalskiy from going further? What did the captain instruct the passenger to do? [40-50 Words]

Ans. The Russian vessel ‘Akademik Shokalskiy’ became stuck in thick ice, preventing it from advancing further toward Antarctica. As the ship could not proceed, the captain instructed the passengers to disembark and venture onto the ice, creating a unique, albeit challenging, experience for them.

14. Why did Geoff Green include young students in his programme? [40-50 Words]

Ans. Geoff Green included young students in the ‘Students on Ice’ programme because they are the future decision-makers. This hands-on experience allowed them to witness environmental issues firsthand, helping them develop a deep understanding and motivating them to actively work towards solving global problems.

15. How has human civilization impacted our environment? Comment with reference to the lesson “Journey to the End of the Earth”. [120-150 Words]

Ans. Human civilization has had a profound impact on the environment, as discussed in the lesson "Journey to the End of the Earth." Despite being a relatively recent species, humans have significantly altered Earth's ecosystems. Population growth, excessive resource consumption, and burning fossil fuels have contributed to global

warming and climate change. The depletion of natural resources and rising carbon emissions have created ecological imbalances, leading to issues like the melting of polar ice caps. This phenomenon is visible in Antarctica, where icebergs are rapidly dissolving due to the rise in global temperatures. The author highlights the importance of acknowledging the damage we have caused to the planet and stresses the need for sustainable practices. The ongoing depletion of the ozone layer, as well as threats to marine life and the carbon cycle, reflect the harmful effects of human activity on Earth's fragile systems.

Chapter- 4 The Enemy

Theme

The theme of The Enemy by Pearl S. Buck centers on compassion, humanity, and moral dilemmas. It explores the internal conflict of Dr. Sadao, a Japanese surgeon, who faces the challenge of saving the life of an American prisoner of war despite his allegiance to his country during wartime.

Character Sketch of Dr Sadao Hoki

- A Japanese doctor who had been educated in the United States
- Sadao is a man of great intelligence and resourcefulness,
- Patriotic but Fair
- Brave and Strong

Character Sketch of Hana

- Wife of Dr. Sadao Hoki,
- Skilled nurse and a supportive partner
- She is quite hardworking
- Better knowledge about medicine
- Compassionate person who feels empathy
- Strong-willed character who is not afraid to speak her mind
- Loves her family

Extract based questions

Q1. Read the following extracts and answer the questions :

"If I am able, are you?" Sadao asked.

"No," Hana said, "But if you can do it alone…"

Sadao hesitated again. "The strange thing is," that if the man were whole I could turn him over to the police without difficulty. I care nothing for him. He is my enemy. All Americans are my enemy. And he is only a common fellow. You see how foolish his face is. But since he is wounded …"

(i) Complete the sentence appropriately.

The dilemma faced by the couple was _____.

Ans. whether to help the wounded American soldier, despite their personal and political conflicts.

(ii) What does Hana ask Dr. Sadao to do alone?

(A) Treat the wounded soldier

(B) Give him shelter in the outhouse

(C) Throw him back into the sea

(D) Hand him over to the authorities

Ans. (A) Treat the wounded soldier

(iii) Explain the expression : “if the man were whole”.

Ans. The expression means if the soldier were not injured, Dr. Sadao would have no moral or ethical conflict in turning him over to the authorities.

(iv) Dr. Sadao says, “All Americans are my enemy.” What character trait of Dr. Sadao does it reflect?

Ans. It reflects Dr. Sadao’s internal conflict and loyalty to his country, which is challenged by his compassion and medical ethics

Q2. Read the following extracts and answer the questions :

But at this moment the door opened and she looked out, a dark-blue woollen haori over her kimono. … He had met Hana in America, but he had waited to fall in love with her until he was sure she was Japanese. His father would never have received her unless she had been pure in her race.

(i) Complete the sentence appropriately.

Hana was attired in _____.

Ans. a dark-blue woollen haori over her kimono.

(ii) With reference to the above, how will you describe Dr. Sadao as a son?

(A) indifferent

(B) obedient

(C) defiant

(D) practical

Ans. (B) obedient

(iii) What is ‘this moment’ all about?

It is a moment of :

(A) emotional turmoil.

(B) tranquility.

(C) agitation.

(D) conflict.

Ans. (A) emotional turmoil.

(iv) From the extract, what can you infer about Dr. Sadao and Hana's relationship?

Ans. Dr. Sadao and Hana's relationship is built on mutual respect and cultural values, as evidenced by Dr. Sadao's decision to wait until he was sure Hana was Japanese before falling in love with her, respecting his father's wishes.

Short type questions

1. What was the servants' reaction to Sadao's decision of treating the American soldier? [40-50 Words]

Ans. The servants were fearful and disapproving of Sadao's choice to treat the American soldier. They were worried about the consequences of aiding an enemy soldier, as they believed it was both dangerous and unpatriotic, possibly leading to severe repercussions for the family.

2. ‘Don’t thank me too early’. Sadao said coldly. What inference is drawn about Sadao’s state of mind from the above line? [40-50 Words]

Ans. From this line, we can infer that although Sadao was providing medical care to the soldier, he remained emotionally distant and uncertain. He might still consider handing over the soldier to the authorities once he recovered, indicating his internal conflict between duty and loyalty.

3. “I must get rid of this man for your sake”. Said Dr. Sadao.

How will you describe Dr. Sadao as a husband with reference to the above line? [40-50 Words]

Ans. Dr. Sadao shows himself to be a loving and protective husband. Despite his commitment to saving the soldier's life, he acknowledges the emotional distress it causes his wife and is willing to take extreme measures to safeguard her peace of mind, reflecting his care and consideration for her.

4. ‘I must get rid of this man for your sake’.

How did Dr. Sadao act like a perfect husband? [40-50 Words]

AnsDr. Sadao demonstrated his devotion as a husband by prioritizing his wife’s emotional well-being. While he was committed to his duty as a doctor to save the soldier, he understood the mental strain it caused her and decided to resolve the situation, reflecting his concern for her comfort.

5. What impression do you form of Dr. Sadao’s father from the story“The Enemy”? [40-50 Words]

Ans Dr. Sadao's father appears to be a figure of moral guidance and wisdom. He instilled in Sadao a strong sense of duty and ethics. However, his son faces a conflict between his professional responsibilities and loyalty to his country, ultimately choosing to uphold humanity over nationalism.

6. What dilemma did Dr. Sadao face about the wounded American soldier? [40-50 Words]

Ans Dr. Sadao faced a moral dilemma when he found the wounded American soldier. As a doctor, he felt compelled to save the soldier's life, but as a patriot, he was obligated to turn him over to the authorities, torn between his professional duty and national loyalty.

7. What risk did Dr. Sadao run in harbouring the enemy American soldier in his house? [40-50 Words]

Ans. By sheltering the American soldier, Dr. Sadao risked being branded a traitor. The servants left his household, and his family was exposed to potential backlash. His children could suffer from the stigma, being labeled the offspring of a man who had aided the enemy.

8. Why was Dr. Sadao not sent abroad with the troops? [40-50 Words]

Ans. Dr. Sadao was not sent with the troops because the General needed his specialized medical expertise. The General considered Dr.

Sadao too valuable to be sent away, particularly due to his skill in treating critical injuries, which the army needed for the ongoing war efforts.

9. Dr. Sadao emerges as a saviour of humanity. Substantiate your answer with evidence from the text. [120-150 Words]

Ans. Dr. Sadao truly exemplifies a savior of humanity. He risks being accused of treason, faces the anger of his servants, and endures personal strain while upholding his duty as a doctor. Even after treating the wounded American soldier and helping him recover, Sadao plans his escape to a nearby island. He ensures the soldier's safety, providing him with the necessary supplies and advice for his escape. While torn between his responsibilities as a doctor and his duty to his country, Sadao fulfills the first by saving the soldier's life. When the General fails to honor his promise to have the soldier killed, Sadao takes matters into his own hands, arranging for the soldier to escape safely, showing his commitment to preserving human life above national loyalty.

Competency based questions

Q1. Dr. Sadao is disturbed and in a dilemma since he has decided to help the enemy soldier. Describe his conflict and the challenges faced in the form of a diary entry. [120-150 Words]

Ans. Dr. Sadao's Diary Entry

[Date]

Today, I am overwhelmed by a deep sense of conflict and inner turmoil. I made a decision that now feels like a heavy burden on my heart—helping an enemy soldier. As a physician, my duty is to preserve life, no

matter the individual's background or allegiance. Yet, offering aid to someone from the opposing side feels like an act of betrayal.

I am torn between my ethical responsibilities and my loyalty to my country. The fear of the repercussions that could fall upon me and my family haunts me. Still, I cannot ignore the sight of a fellow human being in agony, desperately needing medical help. This situation tests my core beliefs and forces me to confront the complexity of human compassion.

I can only hope that my actions, driven by a desire to do what's right, do not lead to regret or harm for those I love. The future remains uncertain.

Dr. Sadao

Q2. After having escaped from Japan with the help of Dr. Sadao, Tom (the prisoner of war) writes an article highlighting how Sadao's actions demonstrated the importance of humanity and living in harmony.

You may begin like this :

Humanity is a value that binds us together …… [120-150 Words]

Ans. Humanity is a universal value that unites us all, transcending borders and conflicts. My personal experience in Japan, where Dr. Sadao saved my life, stands as a testament to the transformative power of compassion and human connection.

Dr. Sadao, a skilled Japanese surgeon, discovered me, an American prisoner of war, stranded near his home. Despite the grave risks to his own life and his family's safety, he made the choice to help me. His

decision was motivated by his duty as a doctor and a profound sense of compassion, rather than the political conflicts of war.

Through this selfless act, Dr. Sadao showed that empathy and kindness can rise above hatred and prejudice. He saw me not as an enemy, but as a fellow human being in need. His extraordinary mercy saved my life and restored my belief in the goodness of people.

To live in peace, we must look past our differences and treat one another with compassion and respect. Dr. Sadao's courage and moral strength remind us that even in the most difficult moments, our shared humanity has the power to lead us to a more harmonious world. His actions exemplify that true heroism lies in upholding the values of compassion, even when faced with adversity.

Thank you.

Q3. "that if the man were whole I could turn him over to the Police ….. . But since he is wounded"

The above statement clearly displays Dr. Sadao's commitment to his profession and compassion. Write an article in appreciation of Dr. Sadao's professional ethics and his ability to rise above prejudices. You may begin like this.

Dr. Sadao proved himself to be a man with great humanitarian values …… [120-150 Words]

Ans. Dr. Sadao demonstrated remarkable humanitarian values when he found himself in a moral dilemma. Faced with the decision of whether to save an injured enemy soldier or let him die, Sadao chose to uphold his duty as a doctor and saved the man's life. Although he initially

planned to turn the soldier over to the authorities once he recovered, his compassion for the soldier's suffering led him to reconsider his stance. He even consulted with the General, who suggested that the soldier be assassinated, but Sadao remained firm in his belief that his role as a doctor was to save lives.

Eventually, Dr. Sadao realized that he could not keep the soldier any longer. When the General failed to send the assassins, Sadao took matters into his own hands and helped the soldier escape. He provided him with food, clothing, and directions to the Korean ships, allowing the soldier to escape to safety. In doing so, Dr. Sadao remained true to his medical oath, fulfilling his duty as a compassionate healer, regardless of political allegiances.

Q4. After seeing off the enemy soldier, Dr. Sadao must have felt relieved.

He was able to uphold the oath that he had taken as a doctor. Dr. Sadao made an entry into his daily diary explaining the dilemma faced by him and how he resolved it.

Imagine yourself to be Dr. Sadao and express his thoughts.

(You may begin like this :

I was able to uphold the oath that I had taken as a doctor…) [120-150 Words]

Ans. 20 March 2022

Dear Diary,

Today, I feel a deep sense of fulfillment, knowing that I was able to uphold the oath I swore as a doctor. My responsibility is to save lives, regardless of the person's nationality. When Tom, the prisoner of war, was found severely injured, I was engulfed in turmoil. Turning him over to the authorities would have meant certain death for him, and I struggled immensely with the consequences of my choices. But in the end, my duty as a doctor prevailed, overcoming the limitations of war and hatred.

The idea of helping a white man angered many of my subordinates. Hana, my wife, assisted me by treating Tom's wounds while I made the difficult decision to operate. I was fully aware of the grave risks I was taking by sheltering the enemy, but my commitment to preserving life could not be swayed.

It was a relief when Tom finally left our home, no longer in pain or anger. I feel a heavy sense of peace now that I have fulfilled my duty.

Dr. Sadao

Chapter – 5 On the face of It

Theme

The theme of On the Face of It by Susan Hill explores the emotional and physical challenges of people with disabilities. It highlights the importance of empathy, understanding, and human connection, focusing on the friendship between two individuals, one with a facial

deformity and the other with a limp, as they share their struggles and desires for acceptance.

Character Sketch of Derry

- 14-year-old boy who suffers from a sense of inferiority complex.
- Physically disabled due to a terrible accident in his childhood
- Scarred face and is blind in one eye.
- This makes him lonely and withdrawn. He avoids the company of others.
- He thinks that people get scared when they look at his horrible face.
- Insecure: Derry feels insecure due to his physical appearance

Character Sketch of Mr. Lamb

- An elderly man who has a tin leg.
- Children called him Lamey- Lamb.
- Alone and kept the doors of his garden open which symbolises his openmindedness towards all Who visited his garden.
- He is a man with a positive attitude.

Extract type of question

Q1. Read the following extracts and answer the questions :

Derry : I….there….I thought this was an empty place. I didn't know there was anybody here…

Mr. Lamb : That's all right. I'm here. What are you afraid of, boy? That's all right.

Derry : I thought it was empty…..an empty house.

Mr. Lamb : So it is. Since I'm out here in the garden. It is empty. Until I go back inside. In the meantime, I'm out here and likely to stop. A day like this. Beautiful day. Not a day to be indoors.

Derry : [Panic] I've got to go.

(i) Derry was stammering because of :

(A) a speech defect.

(B) excitement.

(C) anger.

(D) fear.

Ans. (D) fear.

(ii) Complete the sentence appropriately.

Derry insisted on going back because _____.

Ans. he was afraid of Mr. Lamb and unfamiliar surroundings.

(iii) Mr. Lamb was trying to tell Derry that :

(A) it was a matter of perception.

(B) Derry could stay with him.

(C) he spent all his days in the garden.

(D) he was fond of company.

Ans. (A) it was a matter of perception.

(iv) From the extract, one can infer that Mr. Lamb was a/an :

(A) compassionate man.

(B) mysterious character.

(C) new neighbour.

(D) unreasonable man.

Ans. (A) compassionate man

Q2. Read the following extracts and answer the questions :

Derry : I'd not come to steal anything.

Mr. Lamb : No, no. The young lads steal…… scrump the apples. You're not so young.

Derry : I just……..wanted to come in. Into the garden.

Mr. Lamb : So you did. Here we are, then.

Derry : You don't know who I am.

Mr. Lamb : A boy. Thirteen or so.

Derry : Fourteen. [Pause] But I've got to go now. Good-bye.

Mr. Lamb : Nothing to be afraid of. Just a garden. Just me.

Derry : But I'm not …. I'm not afraid. [Pause] People are afraid of me.

(i) Why does Mr. Lamb feel that Derry has not come to steal?

Ans. Mr. Lamb feels that Derry has not come to steal because Derry's intent appears to be simply exploring the garden and talking to him, rather than stealing.

(ii) Cite instances from the extract which show that Mr. Lamb is trying to put Derry at ease.

Ans. Mr. Lamb addresses Derry kindly, says "Nothing to be afraid of," and reassures him by calling the garden "Just a garden" and himself "Just me."

(iii) Choose the correct statement :

(A) Derry entered the garden as he was fascinated by the bees.

(B) Derry came to meet Mr. Lamb.

(C) They were well acquainted with each other.

(D) Derry entered as he wanted to see the garden.

Ans. (D) Derry entered as he wanted to see the garden.

(iv) People are afraid of Derry because _____.

Ans. of his physical appearance, which makes him feel isolated and judged by others.

Short type questions

1. Why does Derry not like being with people? [40-50 Words]

Ans. Derry avoids being around people because he feels judged and pitied due to his disfigured face. The scars from his accident make him self-conscious, and he often faces isolation and discrimination, which causes him to withdraw from social interactions and feel uncomfortable in others' company.

2. Physically impaired people have to suffer pain and a sense of alienation due to the behaviour of the people around them. It’s ironical that people who should be treated with empathy are either avoided or pitied. Discuss. [120-150 Words]

AnsPhysically impaired individuals not only endure the challenges of their disabilities but also suffer from society's lack of sensitivity and understanding. Instead of receiving the compassion they deserve, they are often subjected to pity or even avoided. This ironic situation highlights a societal failure to treat these individuals with the empathy they need. Derry, in "On the Face of It," is an example of how society's reactions to disabilities can be isolating. He is often treated as an object of pity or alienation rather than being seen as a person with value and potential. True empathy requires us to acknowledge the dignity of individuals with impairments, to support them, and to treat them as equals, integrating them fully into society. Rather than reinforcing their sense of "otherness," we must help them feel included and respected.

3. How does Mr. Lamb try to put Derek at ease when he entered Mr. Lamb's garden? [40-50 Words]

Ans. Mr. Lamb reassures Derek by speaking calmly and kindly when he enters the garden. He recognizes Derek's discomfort and assures him that he is welcome to be there. By showing understanding and accepting Derek's presence without judgment, Mr. Lamb helps him feel more at ease and relaxed.

4. Why does Derry enter Mr. Lamb's garden? [40-50 Words]

Ans. Derry enters Mr. Lamb's garden because he feels isolated due to his disfigured face and assumes the garden is empty. Seeking solitude, he climbs over the wall. However, he is startled when he discovers that Mr. Lamb is there, leading to an unexpected encounter.

5. Derek wants to go back to Mr. Lamb’s house against his mother’s will. What does this tell you about Mr. Lamb? [40-50 Words]

Ans. Derry's desire to return to Mr. Lamb's house, despite his mother's objections, reflects the positive influence Mr. Lamb has had on him. Mr. Lamb has shown Derry a new outlook on life, helping him to see beyond his disability and believe in his potential, which inspires him to seek further guidance.

6. What were the apprehensions of Derry’s mother about his visit to Mr. Lamb? [40-50 Words]

Ans. Derry’s mother was concerned about his visit to Mr. Lamb’s house because she had heard negative rumors about him. Despite their previous visit, she had been warned to stay away from Mr. Lamb and was worried that her son might be influenced by his unconventional lifestyle.

7. What gave Derry the courage to go back to Mr. Lamb’s house despite his mother’s refusal? [40-50 Words]

Ans. Derry gained courage to return to Mr. Lamb’s house because of the confidence Mr. Lamb instilled in him. Mr. Lamb’s acceptance of Derry’s appearance and his uplifting words made Derry believe in his own potential and gave him the strength to defy his mother's objections and return for more guidance.

8. How does Mr. Lamb react when children call him Lamey-Lamb? [40-50 Words]

Ans. When children call him “Lamey-Lamb,” Mr. Lamb remains unbothered. He accepts the fact that he has a prosthetic leg and a limp, and instead of getting upset, he embraces his condition. He does not let others' teasing affect him, showing resilience and a positive attitude.

9. Why does Derry not like being with people? [40-50 Words]

Ans. Derry dislikes being with people because they either pity him or fear him due to his scarred face. His physical appearance makes him feel isolated and rejected, even by his own mother, which contributes to his reluctance to engage with others and his preference for solitude.

10. Why was Derry startled as soon as he entered the garden? [40-50 Words]

Ans. Derry was startled upon entering the garden because he thought it was empty. When he heard Mr. Lamb’s voice, he was surprised and felt guilty for intruding. The unexpected encounter with Mr. Lamb caught him off guard, making him feel uneasy at first.

11. Mr. Lamb stands as a symbol of optimism and hope. Support your answer with examples from the text. [120-150 Words]

Ans. Mr. Lamb represents optimism and hope through his positive attitude despite personal challenges. Though he lost a leg in the war, he lives a fulfilling life. He grows apples, rears bees, and shares his harvest, showing that disability does not hinder a productive life. When children

mock him, calling him “Lamey-Lamb,” he remains unfazed and embraces his condition. He sees life’s beauty in both flowers and weeds, symbolizing his inclusive perspective. His words inspire Derry, a troubled young boy, to embrace his own life and stop feeling sorry for himself. Mr. Lamb teaches him that having a working body and a strong mind are great blessings and that he can overcome any obstacle. Through his wisdom and encouragement, Mr. Lamb helps Derry look beyond his physical scars and realize his full potential, demonstrating the power of hope and a positive mindset.

Competency based questions

Q1. Mr. Lamb : Lord, boy, you’ve got two arms, two legs and eyes and ears ……..

You could get on better than all the rest. Optimism is the best tool to face challenges in life.

Imagine you are Mr. Lamb. You want to give a motivational speech to a group of differently abled students urging them to be positive in their approach to life. Write the speech on behalf of Mr. Lamb.

You may begin like this.

Hello ! Dear Students ! Believe in yourself. Nothing is impossible… (On the Face of it) [120-150 Words]

Ans. Hello, Dear Students!

Believe in yourself—because nothing is impossible when you put your mind to it. You have the strength, the tools, and the potential to achieve far more than you may realize. With two arms, two legs, eyes, and ears, you already possess everything you need to succeed.

Life will present challenges, but it’s your mindset, optimism, and determination that will help you navigate them. Every single one of you faces your own struggles, but how you approach them will make all the difference. Stay positive, recognize your strengths, and never let anyone tell you that you can't reach your dreams. You have the ability to turn your aspirations into reality.

Surround yourself with positive influences, set your goals high, and work with all your heart to achieve them. Your hard work, perseverance, and resilience will lead you to success. Believe in your unique potential and face every day with a smile. You are capable of amazing things, and the world is waiting to see your greatness!

Thank you!

Q2. Derry : Oh no, because if I don’t go back there, I’ll never go anywhere in this world again. (On the Face of it)

Derry later realises that the decision taken at that moment helped him to come out of shell. As Derry, write a diary entry expressing your happiness and thanking your stars for the right decision taken.

You may begin like this.

I was so fortunate to be able to be decisive at the right moment…….. [120-150 Words]

Ans. Dear Diary,

I feel incredibly fortunate that I was able to be decisive when it mattered most. Today, I had to take a stand for myself, or I would have regretted not speaking up. It took so much courage to finally express my thoughts and desires. I had always wanted to visit Mr. Lamb, and today I was able to do just that. His words of encouragement truly changed my perspective.

For the first time in a long while, I felt liberated from the weight of my burned face. It no longer defines me, and I realized that there is so much more to who I am and to life itself than just dwelling on my appearance. I now feel free, light, and empowered to live my life without holding onto past burdens.

Goodbye for now, dear diary.

Q3. Imagine you are Derry speaking at the funeral of Mr. Lamb highlighting Mr. Lamb's optimism and the change he brought about in your attitude towards life.

You may begin like this.

Dear friends,

I will be eternally grateful to Mr. Lamb …… [120-150 Words]

Ans. Dear Friends,

I will be forever grateful to Mr. Lamb for the profound and lasting impact he has had on my life. When we first met, I was overwhelmed by anger and self-pity because of my scarred face. I viewed the world as a hostile and unforgiving place, feeling isolated and disconnected. But Mr. Lamb, with his boundless optimism and compassion, completely transformed my outlook on life.

He taught me to look beyond my physical appearance and to appreciate the beauty and wonder of life itself. He showed me that everyone carries their own burdens, and it is our attitude that defines us, not our outward scars. Mr. Lamb’s garden became a sanctuary of hope, where I learned to embrace life with courage and a positive spirit.

His words and actions have left an indelible imprint on my heart. He made me realize the importance of seeing beyond the surface and finding joy in the simplest things. Mr. Lamb’s legacy will continue to inspire me—and many others—to live with hope and optimism, no matter the obstacles we face.

Thank you.

Q4. Things out, shutting things in.

The above statement speaks about Mr. Lamb’s open mindedness and large heartedness despite his disability. Inspired by his thought, you as a student leader, give a motivational speech to your class on how positive attitude and broad mindedness will help one succeed in life.

You may begin like this.

Good morning to one & all.

Being positive and open minded will definitely make you evolve and grow ……. [120-150 Words]

Ans. Good morning to one and all,

Being positive and open-minded is a key to personal growth and evolution, and Mr. Lamb is a living example of this. His character reflects these two qualities beautifully. He doesn't see weeds as

unwanted; instead, he embraces them, believing that they, like him and Derry, are a part of life. Despite having a tin leg and limping when he walks, Mr. Lamb never lets the teasing by the children, who call him "Lamey Lamb," affect him. He accepts it as a simple fact of life.

Mr. Lamb lives alone, but he keeps the gates of his garden open to everyone, always welcoming visitors. He enjoys talking to people and even finds joy in hearing the bees ‘sing’ in the garden.

His positivity shines through when he encourages Derry, telling him that with his two arms, two legs, eyes, ears, a tongue, and a brain, he can do better than many others. This advice is a reminder that we are all capable of great things if we have the right mindset.

With many friends who visit him and share in the home-made toffees he lovingly makes, Mr. Lamb’s life is a testament to how a positive and open-minded attitude can bring fulfillment and joy. Over the years, he has learned so much, and his example serves as an inspiration to all of us.

Thank you

Q5. Derry : It’s got nothing to do with my face and what I look like.

You do agree with Derry that appearance doesn’t define a person. Only one’s potential and innate qualities gain one respect and dignity in society.

As Derry, write a diary entry regretting how you wasted your time indulging in self-pity and frustration and how your encounter with Mr. Lamb transformed your personality.

You may begin like this.

I do really thank my stars for bringing Mr. Lamb into my life …….. [120-150 Words]

Ans. Dear Diary,

I am truly grateful to the stars for bringing Mr. Lamb into my life. For so many years, I wasted my time wallowing in frustration over my burned face. I was consumed by self-pity and bitterness towards everyone I encountered. I would watch people's reactions when they saw me and, based on their expressions, would grow resentful. I hated my appearance and believed that I could never achieve anything in life because of it.

But meeting Mr. Lamb has completely changed my perspective. He shared how, despite being mocked for his tin leg and limping walk, he had accepted it as part of who he was, and he didn't mind when children teased him. Mr. Lamb made me realize that I am blessed with all four limbs, my eyes, ears, a brain, and a tongue, and that I can achieve anything if I set my mind to it. No one had ever instilled so much positivity and confidence in me before—only pity and judgment.

When Mr. Lamb accepted me as I am, it filled me with so much confidence and joy. I feel like a new person, ready to embrace life and its possibilities. I am beyond thankful to him for changing my life.

Goodbye for now, dear diary

Chapter- 6 Memories of Childhood

Theme

The theme of Memories of Childhood by Two authors, Zitkala-Ša and Bama, reflects on the loss of innocence, cultural identity, and the struggles faced by marginalized communities. Zitkala-Ša recounts her painful experience of cultural assimilation, while Bama portrays the challenges of growing up in a caste-based society, emphasizing resilience and self-awareness.

Character Sketch of Bama

- A small innocent school girl of South India
- A victim of caste discrimination and untouchability.
- She is always curious and pondered about various things- the way in which the tea stall owners poured the tea etc.
- Surprised to see distinction based on class and caste.
- She becomes studious and studies hard to stand first in her class to overcome the discrimination

Extract based question

Q1. Read the following extracts and answer the questions :

I did not open my mouth to answer. Then the steps were quickened and the voices became excited. The sounds came nearer and nearer. Women and girls entered the room. I held my breath and watched them open closet doors and peep behind large trunks. Someone threw up the curtains, and the room was filled with sudden light. What caused them to stoop and look under the bed. I do not know. I remember being dragged out, though I resisted by kicking and scratching wildly. In spite of myself, I was carried downstairs and tied fast in a chair. (Memories of Childhood)

(i) Select the appropriate option :

…….sounds came nearer and nearer…….

(A) describes the increase in volume.

(B) adds suspense and anxiety to readers.

(C) reflects the thought of the speaker.

(D) is a factual narrative.

Ans. (B) adds suspense and anxiety to readers.

(ii) Complete the following sentence :

‘Inspite of myself’ suggests that the speaker was _____.

Ans. ‘Inspite of myself’ suggests that the speaker was resisting.

(iii) What do you infer from the first line of the extract?

(A) It was her first day in school.

(B) She did not want to get caught.

(C) She was unprepared for the lesson.

(D) She preferred to be by herself.

Ans. (B) She did not want to get caught.

(iv) State whether the statement given below is True or False :

The speaker hoodwinked the people looking for her.

Ans. False

Short type question

1. Zitkala-Sa says, “Eating by formula wasn’t the hardest trial in that first day.” What does she mean by ‘Eating by formula’? [40-50 Words]

Ans‘Eating by formula’ refers to the rigid and unfamiliar eating habits imposed at the boarding school. Zitkala-Sa struggled with adapting to these strict routines, which were part of the broader challenge of

adjusting to the new environment that felt oppressive and disconnected from her own cultural practices.

2. “Then I lost my spirit.” What are the incidents that led Zitkala-Sa to feel this way? [40-50 Words]

AnsZitkala-Sa felt she lost her spirit because of the harsh experiences she endured at the boarding school. She was forced to conform to the white man’s customs, including having her hair cut, which stripped her of her identity and left her feeling disconnected from her heritage and culture.

3. “I had been tossed about in the air like a wooden puppet” and now my long hair was shingled like a coward’s…”

What inference about the life of Zitkala-Sa can be drawn from the above statement? [40-50 Words]

Ans. This statement suggests that Zitkala-Sa was treated as though she were powerless, like an object being controlled by others. Being away from her family and subjected to authority figures, she couldn’t stop them from cutting her hair, which, in her culture, symbolized shame and cowardice.

4. Justify the statement, ‘It may take a long time for oppression to be resisted but the seeds of rebellion are sowed early in life. [120-150 Words]

AnsThe statement implies that although resistance to oppression may take time to grow, the desire for change often begins in childhood. In Zitkala-Sa’s case, the early experiences of cultural suppression during

her time at the boarding school ignited a rebellion against the forced assimilation. These early injustices planted the seed for her lifelong fight for cultural preservation and equality. Childhood encounters with oppression provide the initial spark for resistance, often leading to a strong, more organized opposition in adulthood. Through Zitkala-Sa's story, we understand that formative experiences shape one's perspective and contribute to a broader movement for justice and change, even if it takes years to bear fruit.

5. What did Judewin tell the narrator? What was the effect? [40-50 Words]

Ans. Judewin informed Zitkala-Sa that she had overheard a white woman saying her long hair would be cut. This news filled Zitkala-Sa with fear and anxiety, especially because cutting her hair was a serious cultural offense, which made her feel even more vulnerable and disconnected from her roots.

6. How did Zitkala-Sa try to save her long hair? [40-50 Words]

Ans. To prevent her hair from being cut, Zitkala-Sa tried to hide by running to a large room with three white beds and curtains. She crouched beneath a bed, hoping to escape notice, and refused to come out despite being called. However, her efforts to stop the cutting were in vain.

7. What warning did Judewin give to Zitkala-Sa? [40-50 Words]

Ans. Judewin, who knew a few words of English, overheard the white woman discussing the plan to cut their hair. She warned Zitkala-Sa, sharing her concern because, according to their customs, shingling one's hair was a mark of disgrace, associated with captives, mourners, or cowards in their culture.

8. What does Zitkala-Sa mean by "eating by formula"? [40-50 Words]

Ans'Eating by formula' refers to the impersonal, structured manner in which Zitkala-Sa had to eat at the boarding school. The strict meal routines left her with no room for personal choice or cultural practices, making the act of eating feel mechanical, devoid of any personal or cultural connection.

Memories of childhood Part 2 – We Too Are Human Beings

Extract based questions

Q1. Read the following extract and answer the questions that follow:

When I was studying in the third class, I hadn't yet heard people speak openly of untouchability. But I had already seen, felt, experienced and been humiliated by what it is.

I was walking home from school one day, an old bag hanging from my shoulder. It was actually possible to walk the distance in ten minutes. But usually it would take me from half an hour to an hour to dawdle along watching all the fun and games that were going on, all the

entertaining novelties and oddities in the streets, the shops and the bazaar.

(i) The narrator was humiliated because

Ans. The narrator was humiliated because they were teased, called names, and physically assaulted by a group of children from a higher caste while walking home from school. The humiliation was due to their lower caste status, which was stigmatized in the society.

(ii) The narrator ‘dawdled along’ as she _____.

(a) enjoyed looking at the various sights

(b) was getting late for school

(c) she didn’t like going home

(d) she enjoyed haggling and shopping

Ans. (a) enjoyed looking at the various sights

(iii) On the basis of the extract, choose the correct option with reference to the two statements given below :

(I) The distance from school to home was very short.

(II) She was feeling upset and so dawdling her way home.

(a) (I) can be inferred from the extract but (II) cannot

(b) (II) can be inferred from the extract but (I) cannot

(c) Both (I) and (II) cannot be inferred from the extract

(d) Both (I) and (II) can be inferred from the extract

Ans. (c) Both (I) and (II) cannot be inferred from the extract

(iv) The word ‘novelties’ in the passage most nearly means

(a) colourful trinkets

(b) wooden toys

(c) unique and interesting items

(d) expensive souvenirs

Ans. (c) unique and interesting items

Short type questions

1. ‘The words that Annan spoke to me that day made a deep impression on me’.

What inference do you draw about the bond between Annan and Bama? [40-50 Words]

Ans : The relationship between Annan and Bama is one of deep trust and influence. Annan’s words had a lasting effect on Bama, indicating that she highly respects and values his advice. The bond between them is rooted in mutual respect and a strong sibling connection.

2. “The words that Annan spoke to me that day made a deep impression on me.” How was Annan able to inspire Bama? [40-50 Words]

Ans. Annan inspired Bama by explaining that they belonged to a low caste, which subjected them to discrimination by upper-caste people. He emphasized that education was the key to overcoming these hardships. His encouraging words motivated Bama to focus on her studies and strive for a better future.

3. How did Annan’s advice to his sister Bama impact her? [30 – 40 words]

Ans : Annan’s advice left a strong mark on Bama. His encouragement to focus on education and rise above caste-based humiliation made her realize the power of knowledge. She respected his wisdom and the positive direction he offered for her life.

4. Why did Bama stroll in the market place instead of hurrying back home? Describe the sights she enjoyed seeing there. [120 – 150 words]

Ans. Bama lingered in the marketplace, captivated by the lively atmosphere and the various sights. The marketplace was filled with fascinating events and unusual activities, like the performance of a monkey, the snake charmer’s display, and the cyclist who hadn’t dismounted in three days. She was intrigued by the rupee notes pinned on his shirt to encourage him to keep going. Bama also admired the

Maariyaata temple with its large bell, and she was mesmerized by the Pongal offerings being cooked near the temple. She passed by stalls selling dried fish near a statue of Gandhi, as well as sweet treats and fried snacks. The changing colors of the streetlights from blue to violet, the clay beads, and ear-cleaning instruments all added to the charm. These sights and sounds enchanted her, making her lose track of time as she wandered in the bustling market.

Competency based questions

1. In the two stories of Bama and Zitkala-Sa in the lesson of “Memories of Childhood” there are certain similarities of strength in the face of social challenges. Write a diary entry sharing your observations. [120-150 Words]

Ans. 29th July 2024

Dear Diary,

Today, I found myself deeply reflecting on the stories of Bama and Zitkala-Sa from "Memories of Childhood." Their strength and resilience in the face of social discrimination left a profound impact on me. Both girls endured severe prejudice—Bama because of her caste and Zitkala-Sa because of her ethnicity. Despite their young ages, they exhibited incredible resilience and a strong sense of justice.

Bama used her anger and frustration as fuel for academic success, seeing education as a powerful weapon against the caste system. Zitkala-Sa, on the other hand, resisted the cultural assimilation forced upon her by her boarding school, refusing to let go of her Native American identity and traditions.

What stood out to me the most is the inner strength both girls demonstrated. Their stories are a reminder of the power of self-respect and how important it is to stand tall in the face of adversity. Though from different backgrounds, Bama and Zitkala-Sa shared a common determination to fight the injustices they faced and to forge their own paths. Their narratives serve as a powerful reminder of the importance of resisting discrimination and staying true to one's cultural identity.

Goodnight, Diary.

XYZ

2. In the two stories of Bama and Zitkala-Sa in the lesson of "Memories of Childhood" there are certain similarities of strength in the face of social challenges. Write a diary entry sharing your observations. [120-150 Words]

Ans. 29th July 2024

Dear Diary,

Today, I found myself deeply reflecting on the stories of Bama and Zitkala-Sa from "Memories of Childhood." I was truly moved by their strength in facing social challenges and discrimination. Bama experienced prejudice because of her caste, while Zitkala-Sa suffered due to her ethnicity. Despite their young ages, both girls showed remarkable resilience and a strong sense of justice.

Bama used her anger and frustration to fuel her academic achievements, seeing education as a powerful tool against the oppression she faced. Zitkala-Sa, on the other hand, fought against the

cultural erasure imposed by her boarding school, staying true to her Native American heritage and identity.

Their stories serve as a powerful reminder of the importance of inner strength and self-respect in the face of adversity. It’s inspiring to see how both girls, despite coming from different backgrounds, shared a common determination to overcome injustice and carve their own paths. These narratives remind me of the significance of standing up against discrimination and cherishing one’s cultural identity.

Goodnight, Diary.

XYZ